

A Star Fleet Battles™ Rule Proposal

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An enlarged variant of the salvage shuttle (R1.F24), this specialized craft is built on an HTS frame and costs two BPV more than a standard HTS. It has the same retractable gripper/cutter armature and tractor-lifter of the SVS, and the same general background and restrictions of its smaller sibling. An RPS can carry up to 10 spaces of cargo, but its ability to carry boarding parties or crew units is the same as the SVS (most of the size increase of the HTS frame is used up by the repair facilities, and the additional cargo capacity is “squirreled away” in the workspace, rather than as an open volume where beings could sit or stand).

The repair shuttle functions as a single repair system (G17.0) box; however, no power is required, creating an exception to (G17.21). When aboard its home ship/base, and occupying at least one intact shuttle box, the shuttle may function as if it were a powered repair box.

Because the RPS can be launched and move to other ships, it may also function as a “portable” repair system box by landing in the shuttle bay of a receiving ship (the bay must have at least two adjacent unoccupied boxes, and at least one must be undamaged). There is a 16 impulse delay between the RPS landing and when it is eligible to start generating a repair point.

The allocation and effects of its repair point are governed by (G17.26), (G17.3) and (G17.5).

When deployed away from its home ship/base, an RPS may generate a total number of repair points equal to the spaces of carried cargo before it must return to its home ship/base for resupply; this assumes its cargo is filled appropriately, and not with cargo items other than those required for repair. Sufficient cargo might also be supplied by transporter under (G25.2), but each transfer (without regard to the number of cargo spaces transported) requires two turns during which no repair point is generated. Note that when the RPS leaves to return to its home ship/base, the partial repair time limit in (G17.33) applies.

If an RPS is crippled, it cannot function as a repair system box until it is itself repaired (to an uncrippled state) by other means. Notably, it cannot “uncripple” itself; it also cannot repair itself even when uncrippled. An RPS can only function in a shuttle bay of sufficient size to accommodate it (this means it cannot land on the shuttle pad of a PF Leader and repair the PF).

At least one shuttle of this type would be found on most modestly-developed colony worlds, especially if the planet lacked orbital repair facilities and could not afford the upkeep costs of a Salvage Tug (R1.49); they would typically work out of an appropriate Ground base. It was also not uncommon to find them operating in conjunction with (but not necessarily from) an FRD (R1.10); or, from any base capable of operating an HTS, as an adjunct to whatever repair services the base offered.

In wartime, these shuttles were occasionally operated from a LASH skid (R1.68B), or ducktail (R1.69), of a Repair Freighter (R1.25) to enhance its services; however, the shuttle bay of a typical Salvage Tug could not accommodate the HTS frame.

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